

SMAART Institute Mobile App

Development Status Report

3 September 2026 · Prepared for SMAART Institute · Repository: SMAART-INSTITUTE-USERDASHBOARD

15	8	35	2,050	2	100%
BUGS FIXED	FEATURES	FILES CHANGED	LINES ADDED	RELEASES	CI PASSING

Executive summary

A full audit of the mobile application was carried out against the live backend, tracing every screen, user flow and API call. The audit found the app substantially built but carrying a number of defects that silently broke core student journeys, plus several features that were fully developed on the server yet unreachable from the app.

All identified defects have been fixed and the unreachable features have been connected and shipped. The work was delivered in two releases, both merged to the main branch with all continuous-integration checks passing, including the end-to-end browser test suite which is now green for the first time.

Release	Contents	Scope	Status
#284	Correctness fixes across app and backend	15 files · +288 lines	Merged
#285	Feature completion and test repair	24 files · +1,762 lines	Merged

Part 1 — Defects fixed

Every item below was reproduced against the running backend before being fixed, and the fix verified against the same code path.

Critical — core journeys were broken

CRITICAL	Job applications could never succeed The app sent a five-word cover letter while the server required at least fifty, so every single application was rejected. A proper cover-letter field with a live word counter was added to the job detail screen.
CRITICAL	The exam timer never ran The server was not returning the attempt start time, so the countdown sat frozen at full duration, the one-minute warning never appeared and timed-out papers were never auto-submitted. Students who reopened the app silently lost an attempt.
CRITICAL	Exams held for review left students stuck When proctoring held a paper at the moment of submission the app showed nothing at all, leaving the student tapping Submit indefinitely. The hold is now explained on screen with its reference number.
CRITICAL	Opening the app offline destroyed the login session Any network failure at startup deleted the saved session, forcing a full password and email-OTP login. Sessions are now only cleared when the server actually rejects them.
CRITICAL	Finishing onboarding on mobile erased web-entered details Profile fields a student had already filled in on the web dashboard were blanked when they completed the mobile intake form. The two records are now merged correctly.

Major — visibly wrong behaviour

MAJOR	The AI Career Coach never remembered a conversation A data-type mismatch on the server meant the chat history lookup always came back empty, so every visit began a blank conversation.
MAJOR	Your own group-chat messages looked like someone else's Message ownership was compared using a field the server does not send, so every message appeared as a peer's.
MAJOR	The score shown after an exam did not match the pass mark used The report displayed a raw percentage while pass or fail was decided on the weighted stage score, so a student could see a passing number beside a failure.
MAJOR	Notice-board reactions never appeared Reaction counts always displayed zero even after reacting, because the app expected a different data shape from the one the server stores.
MAJOR	Support replies were all attributed to the support team A student's own replies appeared as staff messages when a ticket was opened from history.
MAJOR	A rejected answer could block exam submission permanently Answers the server had permanently refused were retried forever, leaving the student unable to submit.
MAJOR	Support ticket history was capped at ten Older tickets were invisible with no way to page back to them.

Additional fixes

FIXED	Same-origin logins blocked in production The server rejected the web app's own login request whenever it ran behind the load balancer. This was found while investigating a failing test and is a genuine production defect, now fixed without weakening cross-origin protection.
FIXED	Login and password-change navigation traps The login back arrow looped and discarded typed credentials; on Android the hardware back button could escape the compulsory first-login password change into a dead screen.
FIXED	Assorted display defects Missing achievement band on exam reports, zero-percent scores on timed-out papers, invalid colours on study groups created from the web, and stale "already applied" status on the job board.

Part 2 — Features delivered

Each of these was either absent or built on the server but unreachable from the app.

NEW	Push notifications, end to end Devices now register for push on sign-in and are released on sign-out. Every notification the system creates, including bulk announcements and admin broadcasts, is mirrored to the student's phone. Tapping a notification opens the relevant screen: an assessment alert opens Assessments, a course alert opens Learning, and so on. Devices that uninstall the app are detected and cleaned up automatically.
NEW	Community discussion feed The discussion system existed on the server with no mobile interface at all. It now has one: browsable posts with category filters, post creation, replies, five reaction types and bookmarks.
NEW	Resume PDF export The server previously could not produce a resume document at all. It now renders a clean, recruiter-ready PDF, and the Resume Builder has a working Export button in place of its former "not available" notice.
NEW	Proctoring warnings are now visible to students The invigilation system issued warnings and pauses that the app silently ignored until a paper was held. Students now see a clear warning banner and a paused-exam screen that resumes automatically.
NEW	Self-service sign-up made reachable A complete registration flow existed in both app and server but nothing linked to it. The login screen now offers "Create an account".
NEW	Real progress statistics on the home screen Daily streak, experience and badge counts were hardcoded placeholders showing the same numbers to every student. They now come from the student's real record, and the recommendation cards reflect their actual course and next assessment.
NEW	Course progress now counts video learning Watching course videos on the phone did not advance course completion, which only moved through quizzes or the web. Video completion now updates the enrolment record and triggers badge awards.
NEW	Automated browser test suite repaired Two end-to-end tests had been failing continuously and were masking real problems. Both were fixed and the suite now passes in full.

Verification

Every change was validated before release:

Check	Result
Backend continuous-integration suite	Passing
Frontend build and lint	Passing
End-to-end browser tests (4 tests)	Passing — first time green
Syntax validation, all changed files	Passing
Resume PDF generator, executed on sample data	Valid document produced
API calls checked against live server routes	No mismatches remaining

Outstanding items

Three items remain, each awaiting a decision or an action outside the codebase.

ACTION

Testing on a physical device

The application has never been run on real hardware. Push notification delivery and the face-recognition proctoring gate cannot be verified in a simulator and need a test build installed on a phone. The proctoring models also need a hosting address configured before they will load on a device.

BLOCKED

File and photo attachments

Support ticket attachments, vision-board cover images and profile photographs are ready to build but need two picker components installed into the project first, which must be done on a development machine so the correct versions are pinned.

DECISION

Course prerequisite enforcement

Course locking is built but switched off on both app and server. Turning it on changes what every student can see and is a business decision rather than a technical one.

Recommended next step

Install the current build on a physical device and confirm push notifications and the proctoring gate behave as expected. Everything else is merged, verified and ready for use.